

Human Resources & Leave Policies

Official Employee Handbook | Effective January 2025 | Version 3.2

Table of Contents

1. Introduction & Scope
2. Types of Leave
3. Annual & Earned Leave
4. Sick Leave & Medical Policy
5. Maternity, Paternity & Adoption Leave
6. Special & Miscellaneous Leave
7. Leave Without Pay (LWP)
8. Attendance, Punctuality & Remote Work
9. Public Holidays
10. Leave Application Process
11. Disciplinary Framework
12. Grievance Redressal

1. Introduction & Scope

This Human Resources and Leave Policy document has been prepared to provide all employees with a comprehensive understanding of the entitlements, obligations, and procedures governing leave and attendance within the organisation. These policies apply to all permanent, probationary, and contractual employees unless explicitly stated otherwise.

The organisation is committed to creating a workplace that values employee well-being, promotes work-life balance, and ensures fair treatment for every individual regardless of their role or seniority. This document supersedes all previous versions and verbal or informal arrangements.

The HR department is the custodian of these policies and reserves the right to amend, update, or revise any clause herein with due notice. Employees are encouraged to regularly review the latest version available on the HR portal and direct any queries to their designated HR Business Partner.

2. Types of Leave

The organisation provides a comprehensive range of leave types designed to cover various personal, medical, and family circumstances. The following table provides a high-level summary of all available leave categories:

Leave Type	Days/Year	Paid?	Carry Forward?
Annual / Earned Leave	18 days	Yes	Up to 30 days
Sick Leave	10 days	Yes	No
Casual Leave	6 days	Yes	No
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Yes	N/A
Paternity Leave	10 days	Yes	No
Bereavement Leave	5 days	Yes	No
Marriage Leave	5 days	Yes	No
Study / Exam Leave	5 days	Unpaid	No
Leave Without Pay	As needed	No	N/A

3. Annual & Earned Leave

Every confirmed full-time employee is entitled to 18 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave accrues at the rate of 1.5 days per month, starting from the date of confirmation. Employees

on probation accrue leave at 1 day per month but may only utilise it after probation is successfully completed.

Key Rules for Annual Leave:

- Leave must be applied for a minimum of **5 working days** in advance through the HR portal.
- Approval is subject to business requirements and the discretion of the reporting manager.
- Up to **30 days** of unused annual leave may be carried forward to the next calendar year.
- Any leave beyond 30 days in balance will lapse at the end of the calendar year.
- Employees may encash up to **10 days** of unused annual leave per year during the December payroll cycle.
- Annual leave cannot be taken during the notice period unless explicitly approved by HR.
- Leave taken in excess of entitlement will be treated as Leave Without Pay (LWP).

For employees who join mid-year, their annual leave entitlement will be calculated on a pro-rata basis. Similarly, employees who resign mid-year will have their leave balance settled in the full and final settlement, with excess leave recovered from outstanding dues.

4. Sick Leave & Medical Policy

The organisation recognises that illness is unavoidable and provides 10 days of fully paid sick leave per year to all employees. Sick leave is non-cumulative and cannot be carried forward to the next year or encashed under any circumstances.

Procedures for Sick Leave:

- Employees must inform their immediate supervisor and HR via the portal **before 10:00 AM** on the day of absence.
- For absences of **1–2 days**, self-declaration through the HR portal is sufficient.
- For absences of **3 or more consecutive days**, a medical certificate from a registered practitioner must be submitted within 2 working days of return.
- Frequent or patterned sick leave (e.g., Mondays, Fridays, or days adjacent to holidays) may be subject to review.
- In cases of serious illness requiring extended absence, the employee must submit a fitness certificate before resuming work.
- Employees who exhaust their sick leave entitlement will have further absences treated as LWP.

The organisation also provides an **Employee Assistance Programme (EAP)** offering confidential counselling and mental health support. Mental health-related absences will be treated with the same sensitivity and confidentiality as physical health conditions.

5. Maternity, Paternity & Adoption Leave

The organisation is fully compliant with the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017 and is committed to supporting employees during significant life events such as childbirth and adoption.

Maternity Leave:

Female employees who have completed at least 80 days of work in the 12 months preceding the expected delivery date are entitled to 26 weeks of fully paid maternity leave for their first two children. For the third child onwards, the entitlement is 12 weeks. In case of illness arising out of pregnancy, an additional 30 days of leave may be granted with supporting documentation.

Paternity Leave:

Male employees are entitled to 10 working days of fully paid paternity leave, which must be availed within 6 months of the birth or legal adoption of the child. Proof of birth or adoption must be submitted to HR within 30 days.

Adoption Leave:

Commissioning mothers and adoptive parents are entitled to 12 weeks of leave upon adoption of a child below the age of 3 months. Documented legal proof of adoption must be provided.

6. Special & Miscellaneous Leave

- **Bereavement Leave:** 5 paid days upon the passing of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling). 2 days for extended family. Documentation may be requested.
- **Marriage Leave:** 5 paid days for the employee's own marriage, availed within 6 months of the event. A marriage certificate must be submitted.
- **Study / Exam Leave:** Up to 5 days of unpaid leave per year for professional examinations relevant to the employee's role. Approval by the department head is mandatory.
- **Jury Duty / Legal Obligation:** Paid leave for court appearances or civic duties, supported by official documentation.
- **Voluntary / CSR Leave:** 1 paid day per year for participation in approved CSR activities or community service.
- **Voting Leave:** Half a day on election day if the employee's polling booth is not within reasonable distance of the workplace.

7. Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Leave Without Pay may be granted when an employee has exhausted all entitled leaves and requires additional time off for legitimate personal reasons. LWP is not a right but may be considered at management discretion.

- LWP for up to **5 days** requires approval from the reporting manager.
- LWP from **6 to 30 days** requires approval from the department head and HR.
- LWP exceeding **30 days** requires Director-level and HR Director approval.
- LWP may affect performance appraisal ratings, increment cycles, and statutory benefits.
- LWP for more than 60 continuous days may result in service discontinuity as per applicable labour law.

8. Attendance, Punctuality & Remote Work

All employees are expected to maintain a minimum attendance of **85% per quarter**. Attendance is recorded via biometric systems or digital login on the company's HRMS platform. Consistent tardiness or early departures without valid reason are subject to disciplinary action.

Employees approved for hybrid or remote work must be reachable during core hours (10:00 AM – 5:00 PM) and must log attendance daily. Remote work arrangements are subject to quarterly review and may be revoked based on performance or business needs.

9. Public Holidays

The organisation observes all national and regional public holidays as per the applicable state government calendar. A holiday list is published at the beginning of each year on the HR portal. Employees required to work on a public holiday are entitled to a compensatory day off or additional pay at 1.5x the daily rate, as per applicable law.

10. Leave Application Process

All leave applications must follow the process outlined below:

Step	Action
Step 1	Log in to the HR portal and navigate to 'Leave Management'.
Step 2	Select the leave type and specify the dates requested.
Step 3	Provide a brief reason for the leave request.
Step 4	Submit the application. Your reporting manager receives an automated notification.
Step 5	Manager approves or rejects within 2 working days. You will receive an email notification.
Step 6	For medical or emergency leave, the application may be submitted retrospectively within 2 work

11. Disciplinary Framework

Violations of leave and attendance policies will be handled through the organisation's standard disciplinary process, which includes verbal warning, written warning, final written warning, and potential termination for repeated or serious violations. Employees have the right to respond to any disciplinary action and may escalate concerns through the grievance mechanism.

12. Grievance Redressal

Employees who believe their leave application has been unjustly denied or that any policy has been applied unfairly may raise a formal grievance with the HR department within **7 working days** of the decision. The grievance must be submitted in writing via the HR portal or by email to hr.grievances@company.com.

The HR team will acknowledge the grievance within 2 working days and complete a review within **15 business days**. If the employee is not satisfied with the outcome, they may escalate to the HR Director. The organisation is committed to a fair, transparent, and respectful resolution process for

all workplace concerns.

*This document was last reviewed and approved by the HR Director in January 2025. For queries, contact:
hr@company.com*